

FREE PLAYBOOK

The Clinic Front Desk Playbook

For med spas, hair transplant clinics, and beauty clinics.

The systems that keep your schedule full while your team stays with clients. The missed-call, after-hours, and no-show fixes, in the order we install them. The honest math, with your numbers, not ours.

Read it once. Fill in the math. Install in order.

This is for the owner, co-owner, or clinic manager of an independent clinic with a small team: two to ten people, one to three locations. You are the person who notices the phone rang during a treatment and nobody could get to it.

Every page is written for someone who runs the front desk or pays the person who does. No vendor pitch, no software tour. Each system is described by what the client experiences, what your team sees, and the one number that tells you it is working.

Who this fits

- ✓ **Med spas** that run on memberships and maintenance visits, where a missed recall is a missed month.
- ✓ **Hair transplant clinics** where a consult is high value, the research phase is long, and inquiries arrive by DM and web form at all hours, often from out of town.
- ✓ **Beauty and aesthetics clinics** with high visit volume, where a few no-shows a day quietly empty the afternoon.

What this is not

- Not clinical guidance. Nothing here touches treatment decisions, and none of these systems should either.
- Not a promise. We do not publish industry averages or client results here. You will use your own numbers on page 4.
- Not legal advice. Page 11 covers consent and guardrails in plain terms; your compliance person has the final word.

THE ORDER MATTERS

Pages 6 through 10 are five systems. They are ordered by how fast they go live and how little they change your team's day. Each one also feeds the next: text-back creates the lead that after-hours booking converts, which no-show defense protects, which recall brings back.

The five leaks

Small clinics lose bookings in the same five places. None of them show up on a report, because a call that was never answered and a DM that was never opened do not create a record. They just do not become a consult.

LEAK	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE ON A TUESDAY	THE FIX
Missed calls	Your injector is mid-treatment, the front desk is checking someone out, the phone rings four times and stops. The caller books with whoever picks up next.	Missed-call text-back, page 6
After-hours inquiries	A form comes in at 9:40 pm. Someone reads it at 10 am. By then the person has already filled out three other forms.	After-hours booking, page 7
No-shows and late cancels	Two consults do not show. The room sits empty, the provider is paid anyway, and nobody on the waitlist was told a slot opened.	No-show defense, page 8
Unanswered DMs and forms	Instagram DMs, Google Business messages, website chat, and the contact form are four inboxes checked by whoever remembers.	Lead and DM follow-up, page 9
Lapsed clients	Clients who were due back months ago and never got a nudge. The most affordable consult you will ever book is one with someone who already trusts you.	Recall and reactivation, page 10

Why this happens at good clinics

Not because the team is careless. Because the person best placed to answer is also the person delivering the service. Every one of these leaks is a moment where a human was busy doing the thing clients pay for. The systems in this playbook take the interruption, not the relationship.

The honest math

Fill this in with your own figures from the last full month. If you do not know one, estimate low. A conservative number you believe beats an industry average you do not.

A. Missed calls

Missed calls per week _____ × share that would have booked (guess low)

_____ × value of a first visit _____

= weekly leak _____ × 4 = monthly _____

B. No-shows

Consults booked per week _____ × no-show and late-cancel rate _____ ×
value of a first visit _____

= weekly leak _____ × 4 = monthly _____

C. Slow follow-up

Inbound DMs and forms per week _____ × share answered after more than an hour
_____ × share of those that go quiet _____ × value of a first visit

= weekly leak _____

D. Lapsed clients

Clients overdue for a return visit _____ × share who rebook when nudged (guess low)
_____ × value of a return visit _____

= one-time recovery _____

How to read the result

Add A, B, and C for a monthly figure. That is the ceiling on what a front desk that never misses could add. You will not capture all of it, and nobody should tell you otherwise. The point is to see which leak is biggest for your clinic, because that decides where to start if you cannot start everywhere.

We do not publish averages or guarantees for patient volume or revenue. Your clinic is not an average, and a playbook that pretends otherwise is selling you something.

The install order, and why

Fastest to live and least disruptive first. Each step creates the conditions for the next one to work.

1

Missed-call text-back. Live in days. Touches nothing in your workflow: the phone still rings the same way. It only acts when nobody answers. Immediate, visible, and it proves the approach to a skeptical team.

2

After-hours booking. Now that a text conversation starts when a call is missed, let it finish the job: answer the common questions, offer real openings, and book the consult while the person is still interested. Requires a connection to your scheduler.

3

No-show defense. More bookings means more chances to no-show. Confirmations, reminders that ask for a reply, easy rescheduling, and a waitlist that backfills a cancelled slot within minutes.

4

Lead and DM follow-up. Bring Instagram, Google Business, web chat, and forms into one queue with one response standard. This one changes how the team works, so it goes after the wins above have earned trust.

5

Recall and reactivation. Last because it depends on clean records and on the booking path from step 2 being solid. When a lapsed client says yes, the system must be able to book them without a human in the loop.

IF YOU CAN ONLY DO ONE

Do step 1. It is the cheapest to run, the fastest to see, and it produces the first hard number in your scoreboard: calls recovered. Everything else can wait a month. That one should not.

Missed-call text-back

What it does. When a call goes unanswered during business hours, a text goes to the caller within seconds, from your clinic number, that acknowledges the miss and opens a conversation. Voicemail stays. This runs alongside it.

What the client experiences

Hi, this is Northline Aesthetics. Sorry we missed your call, we're with a client. How can we help? Reply here or we'll call you back within the hour. Reply STOP to opt out.

Clinic name, tone, and the callback window are yours to set. Keep it human and short.

What your team sees

- One shared inbox showing the missed call, the text, and any reply.
- A flag when the caller replies with intent ("price", "book", "availability") so a human can step in.
- A daily count of calls missed and calls recovered.

Guardrails

- Only fires on unanswered calls from mobile numbers during hours you define. Never texts a landline or a number on your do-not-contact list.
- One text per missed call. If the person does not reply, no chasing.
- Questions about treatments, suitability, or medical history are routed to a person, not answered.

Setup checklist

- ✓ Confirm your phone system can report a missed call (most VoIP and cloud phone systems can).
- ✓ Register your clinic number for business texting with your carrier so messages deliver.
- ✓ Write the one message above in your voice. Approve it once.
- ✓ Decide who owns the inbox for replies, and the callback window you can actually keep.

Measure: missed calls per week, text-backs delivered, replies received, consults booked from those replies.

After-hours booking

What it does. Outside business hours, and during them when the desk is buried, an assistant answers the common questions by text and web chat, offers real openings from your scheduler, and books the consult. The morning starts with appointments on the calendar instead of forms to chase.

What it handles on its own

QUESTION	ANSWER SOURCE
Hours, location, parking	Your approved FAQ.
"Do you offer X?"	Your service list, by name only. No suitability advice.
"How much is a consult?"	Only what you have approved to quote. Otherwise: "The consult covers that."
"When can I come in?"	Live openings from your scheduler, filtered to consult slots.
"Can I reschedule?"	Yes, within the rules you set (notice period, provider).

What it hands to a person

- Anything about medical history, medications, pregnancy, allergies, or whether a treatment is right for them.
- Complaints, refund requests, and anything with heat in it.
- Out-of-town and travel planning for hair transplant consults, once the first appointment is held.

Client: do u have anything this week for a hair consult
 Assistant: We do. Thursday 2:15 pm and Friday 10:30 am are open for a consultation with Dr. Reyes. Both are about 45 minutes. Want one of those?
 Client: friday
 Assistant: Booked: Friday 10:30 am, consultation, Dr. Reyes. You'll get a confirmation text now and a reminder the day before. Anything you'd like the team to know ahead of time?

Names and slots are illustrative. The assistant only offers times your scheduler actually shows as open.

Measure: conversations started after hours, consults booked after hours, questions escalated to a person.

No-show defense

What it does. Every booked consult gets a confirmation that asks for a reply, a reminder with a one-tap reschedule, and a same-day check. When a slot opens, the waitlist is offered it within minutes, first come first served, without a phone call.

The sequence

WHEN	MESSAGE	PURPOSE
On booking	Confirmation with date, time, provider, address. "Reply YES to confirm."	Catch typos and second thoughts early.
48 hours before	Reminder with a reschedule link and your cancellation window.	Move the change to a time you can refill.
Morning of	Short reminder. Parking, what to bring, how long it takes.	Reduce the "forgot" no-show.
No reply by cutoff	Flag to a human for a quick call.	A person decides, not the system.
Slot opens	Waitlist offer: "A 2:15 pm opened today. Want it? Reply YES."	Refill without the phone tree.

Rules that keep it from being annoying

- Never more than three messages per appointment unless the client replies.
- Reminders stop the moment someone confirms.
- Rescheduling is one tap and never punished. A moved consult is not a lost one.
- Your deposit or cancellation policy, if you have one, is stated once at booking and never argued by the assistant.

Setup checklist

- ✓ Define your consult slot types and which providers take them.
- ✓ Write your cancellation window in one sentence.
- ✓ Turn on the waitlist in your scheduler, or keep a simple list the system can read.
- ✓ Pick the human who gets the "no reply" flag each morning.

Measure: confirmations received, no-shows per week, slots refilled from the waitlist, reschedules kept.

Lead and DM follow-up

What it does. Instagram DMs, Facebook messages, Google Business messages, website chat, and the contact form land in one queue. The first reply goes out fast, asks the one qualifying question, and moves the person toward a booked consult. Your team works one list instead of five apps.

The response standard

First reply within 15 minutes, during the hours you choose. Not a canned "thanks, we'll get back to you." A real answer to what they asked, plus one question that moves it forward. After hours, the System 2 assistant handles it and books if the person is ready.

The one question

Every inbound message gets one qualifying question, chosen by channel and service. Examples you can adapt:

- **Hair transplant inquiry:** "Are you looking to book a consultation, or still researching? Either is fine, I can help with both."
- **Injectables or skin:** "Have you been in before, or would this be a first visit?"
- **Price-only question:** "Happy to share what I can. Are you comparing options for a specific concern?"

The question does the sorting. Ready people get an opening. Researching people get a short, honest answer and a soft follow-up in a few days, then nothing more unless they reply.

What the team sees

- One inbox, newest unanswered first, with the channel and the service tagged.
- A timer on every unanswered message so the 15-minute standard is visible.
- A weekly view: messages in, answered within standard, consults booked, by channel.

Guardrails

- Before-and-after photos, results, and "will this work for me" go to a provider or a trained person, never the assistant.
- No message sends to a platform where the client has not messaged you first.
- Follow-ups cap at two. Silence is an answer.

Measure: inbound messages per week, share answered within 15 minutes, consults booked by channel.

Recall and reactivation

What it does. Clients who are due for a return visit get a personal nudge at the right interval, with an opening they can take in one reply. Clients who have gone quiet for a long stretch get one honest check-in. Both book straight into your scheduler through System 2.

Two lists, two tones

DUE BACK

Based on the interval your provider set for that service. Neutral and useful, like a dentist's reminder.

Hi Maya, it's Northline. You're coming up on the window Dr. Reyes suggested for your next visit. Thursday 3 pm or next Tuesday 11 am are open if either works. Reply with one, or "later" and we'll check back in a month.

GONE QUIET

No visit in a long stretch. One message, once. Not a promotion.

Hi Maya, it's Northline. It's been a while and we wanted to check in. If you'd like to come back, I can find you a time. If not, no problem at all, and you won't hear from us again about this. Reply STOP to opt out.

Rules

- Intervals are set by your provider per service. The system never invents a return date.
- "Later" is honored to the day. "No" is honored forever.
- Reactivation goes out in small batches so the desk can absorb the replies.
- No discounts by default. If you choose to offer one, it is your call, stated once.

Setup checklist

- ✓ Export the last visit date and service for every active client. This is the only data the system needs.
- ✓ Have each provider set a return interval per service, or mark "none."
- ✓ Approve the two messages above in your voice.
- ✓ Choose the batch size per day your team can handle.

Measure: recall messages sent, replies, return visits booked, "later" and "no" honored.

Consent, privacy, and what the assistant never does

Plain-language rules we build into every install. This is not legal advice. Your compliance person, and your state's rules, have the final say.

Texting consent

- A client who calls or messages you first has opened a conversation. Replying to that is fine. Marketing to them later is a separate permission.
- Every automated text includes a way to opt out, and opt-outs are honored instantly and permanently.
- Your booking form and intake paperwork should include one clear line asking for permission to text about appointments. Keep a record of who said yes.

Health information

- Messaging and marketing tools are for scheduling and logistics. Medical history, photos, and treatment notes stay in your clinical record system, not in a text thread.
- If your clinic is a medical practice, any vendor that touches patient information needs a written agreement covering privacy. Ask before you connect anything.
- The assistant does not ask for, store, or repeat health details. If a client volunteers them, the thread is handed to a person.

What the assistant never does

- Gives treatment advice or says whether a procedure is right for someone.
- Quotes a price you have not approved, or negotiates one.
- Makes a claim about results, timelines, or outcomes.
- Messages someone who asked not to be messaged.
- Pretends to be a person when asked directly.

What stays human

The consult. The clinical conversation. The complaint. The client who is upset. The judgment call on a no-reply. The systems in this playbook exist to protect the team's time for exactly those moments, not to replace them.

The weekly scoreboard

Seven numbers, once a week, on one page. If a number is not moving, the system behind it needs attention. If you cannot get a number, that is the first thing to fix.

NUMBER	THIS WEEK	LAST WEEK	SYSTEM
Calls missed			1
Calls recovered by text			1
Consults booked after hours			2
No-shows and late cancels			3
Slots refilled from the waitlist			3
Messages answered within 15 minutes			4
Return visits booked from recall			5

Booked consults are the number that matters. Everything else explains it.

NEXT STEP

Want it installed?

We build and run these systems for independent clinics in Dallas to Fort Worth, on the scheduler and phone system you already use, implementation included. Three retainers, described on the site. Most independent clinics land on Core.

A strategy call is fifteen minutes. Bring page 4. We will tell you which leak to close first and what it takes, and if we are not the right fit, we will say so.

BOOK A STRATEGY CALL

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